

Payment Policy

Last updated: January 2025

Overview

This document explains the payment methods we accept, how transactions are processed, what happens when a payment fails, how we handle disputes and chargebacks, and how we protect your financial information.

1. Accepted Payment Methods

1.1 Credit and Debit Cards

We accept all major credit and debit cards including:

- Visa
- Mastercard
- American Express
- Discover
- Diners Club (select regions)

Your card is charged at the time of order placement for in-stock items. For pre-orders and back-ordered items, your card is charged when the item ships.

1.2 Digital Wallets

- Apple Pay: available on Safari and the iOS app
- Google Pay: available on Chrome and the Android app
- PayPal: log into your PayPal account at checkout to pay with your PayPal balance, linked bank, or PayPal credit
- Shop Pay: fast one-tap checkout with stored payment details

1.3 Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL)

We partner with the following BNPL providers:

- Klarna: split into 4 interest-free payments, or flexible monthly financing
- Afterpay: split into 4 fortnightly interest-free installments
- Affirm: monthly payment plans from 3 to 36 months (subject to credit approval)

BNPL options appear at checkout for eligible orders. Minimum order amounts apply. BNPL is subject to approval by the respective provider. Refunds on BNPL orders are handled in

coordination with the provider — credits are applied to your BNPL installment plan, which may affect your payment schedule.

1.4 Gift Cards and Store Credit

Gift cards and store credit can be applied at checkout. Multiple gift cards can be combined. Gift cards cannot be applied to subscription purchases.

1.5 Bank Transfer (ACH)

ACH transfers are available for Business plan customers and orders over \$500. ACH payments take 3 to 5 business days to clear. Orders paid by ACH are held until payment clears before shipping.

1.6 Cryptocurrencies

We currently do not accept cryptocurrency payments.

2. Currency And International Payments

2.1 Base Currency

All prices are displayed and charged in US Dollars (USD) by default.

2.2 Local Currency Display

Customers browsing from outside the United States can select their local currency for price display using the currency selector in the website header. Displayed local currency prices are estimates based on live exchange rates. Your card or payment provider will handle the final conversion and may apply a foreign transaction fee.

2.3 Foreign Transaction Fees

We do not charge foreign transaction fees. However, your bank or card issuer may charge one (typically 1% to 3%). Check with your financial institution if this is a concern.

3. Payment Security

3.1 PCI DSS Compliance

We are fully compliant with Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard (PCI DSS) Level 1, the highest certification level. We do not store your full card number on our servers — card data is tokenized and handled by our certified payment processor.

3.2 Secure Checkout

All payment pages use TLS 1.2 or higher encryption (indicated by the padlock icon in your browser). Never enter payment details on a page without HTTPS.

3.3 Two-Factor Authentication for High-Value Orders

Orders above \$300 may trigger an additional authentication step (3D Secure / Verified by Visa / Mastercard SecureCode). You may receive an SMS code or be redirected to your bank's authentication page. This is normal and protects you from unauthorized use of your card.

3.4 Fraud Detection

Our automated fraud detection system analyzes orders in real time. Orders flagged for review may be held for up to 24 hours while we verify the transaction. We may contact you by phone or email for verification. You are not charged for orders held for review until the order is confirmed.

4. Failed Payments

4.1 Why a Payment Might Fail

Common reasons include:

- Insufficient funds
- Card expired or incorrect expiry date entered
- Billing address does not match the card issuer's records
- Bank declined the transaction as suspicious (call your bank to authorize)
- Daily spending limit reached

4.2 What Happens When a Payment Fails

Your order is not placed. You will see an error message at checkout specifying the reason (if available from your bank). No hold or charge is made to your card in the event of a complete failure. However, some banks show a temporary "authorization hold" that typically disappears within 3 to 5 business days.

4.3 Updating Payment and Retrying

If your payment fails, you can:

- Correct your card details and retry immediately
- Use a different payment method at checkout
- Contact your bank to authorize the transaction, then retry

5. Authorization Holds

When you place an order, we place a temporary authorization hold on your card for the full order amount. This hold is not a charge — it is a reservation of funds. The actual charge posts when your order ships. If your order is cancelled before shipment, the hold is released. Release times vary by bank (typically 3 to 10 business days).

For split-shipment orders, you may see multiple smaller charges as each shipment is dispatched.

6. Invoices And Receipts

6.1 Order Receipts

A receipt is automatically emailed to the address on file after each successful payment. Receipts are also available in Account > Order History > View Receipt.

6.2 VAT and Tax Invoices

If you require a formal VAT or tax invoice (for business expense purposes), email billing@shopexample.com with your order number and business details (company name, VAT/tax ID). We will generate and send a formal invoice within 2 business days.

6.3 Subscription Invoices

Subscription billing receipts are sent automatically after each renewal. Historical subscription invoices are available in Account > Billing History.

7. Payment Disputes And Chargebacks

7.1 Resolve Issues With Us First

Before disputing a charge with your bank, please contact our support team. Most billing issues are resolved faster directly with us than through the chargeback process. You can reach us at billing@shopexample.com.

7.2 Unauthorized Charges

If you see a charge from us that you did not authorize, contact us immediately at security@shopexample.com. We will investigate and refund unauthorized charges confirmed to be fraudulent within 5 business days.

7.3 Chargeback Process

If you initiate a chargeback (dispute the charge with your card issuer), we will receive a notification and respond to the dispute with the relevant order and delivery documentation.

Initiating a chargeback while an order is in transit or a return is being processed may complicate resolution. We encourage you to work with us directly first.

7.4 Chargeback Consequences

If a chargeback is found to be fraudulent or in bad faith (e.g., item was received but reported as not received), we reserve the right to:

- Suspend or close the associated account
- Flag the account for future order review
- Pursue recovery of funds in accordance with applicable law

8. Promotional Codes And Discounts

8.1 Applying Promo Codes

Enter your promo code in the designated field at checkout. Codes are case-sensitive. Only one promo code can be applied per order (unless stated otherwise in the promotion terms). Promo codes cannot be applied retroactively to completed orders.

8.2 Promo Code Restrictions

- Some codes are valid only for specific product categories
- Minimum order value requirements may apply
- Codes may exclude sale items or subscriptions
- Expired codes cannot be reactivated

8.3 Price Adjustments

If an item you purchased goes on sale within 7 days of your order date, you may be eligible for a one-time price adjustment credit. Contact support with your order number within 7 days of the sale start. Price adjustments are issued as store credit, not as a refund to your payment method. This applies once per order.

9. Tax Collection

Sales tax is collected for orders delivered to states where we are required to do so by law. The applicable tax rate is calculated based on the delivery address and item type. Tax amounts are displayed at checkout before you confirm payment. If you are a tax-exempt organization, contact billing@shopexample.com before placing your order with your exemption documentation.

10. Contact For Payment Issues

Billing inquiries: billing@shopexample.com

Unauthorized charges or fraud: security@shopexample.com

Phone: 1-800-555-0199 (Monday to Friday, 9 AM to 6 PM Eastern)